

# Bones and muscles

You would be like a lump of jelly without your skeleton—a frame of bones that holds you up and protects your internal organs.

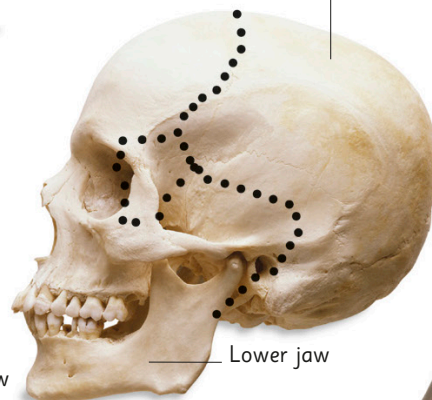
## Bending backbone

Your backbone contains 24 small bones called vertebrae. They move almost every time you do.

The vertebrae in your back allow you to twist and bend.

## Head case

The bones that make up your skull join after you are born. The skull has two parts—the lower jaw and cranium. Only your jaw can move.



Lower jaw

Bone marrow supplies your body with red blood cells.

The honeycomb structure of some bones makes them weigh less than if they were solid.

## Brilliant bone

Bones have a clever structure that makes them light but strong. They can heal themselves if broken.

Snake rib cages can run almost the entire length of their bodies.



## Rib cage

A rib cage has long, curved bones that protect vital organs such as the heart and lungs.

Both the knee and elbow are hinged joints that only move in one direction.

The hip is a ball-and-socket joint, allowing the legs to move around.

Backbone

The wrist is made up of eight small bones.

Cranium

Rib cage

Skull